CORE FALSE BELIEF #1 · MY WORTH

“Something is wrong with me.”

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Where it often comes from

This belief often starts early. A child who is criticized, compared, ignored, teased, or treated as a problem can conclude, “The trouble must be me.” Painful experiences such as abuse, rejection, divorce, or a parent’s anger can leave the same message, because children tend to blame themselves for what adults do. Later, every mistake, struggle, or difference seems to confirm it. Over time the feeling of being “broken” or “not like other people” can settle in so deeply that it feels like a fact rather than a belief.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that every person is affected by sin and lives in a broken world. But the Bible never says that you are uniquely defective or that you are the one thing God got wrong. You were made in God’s image. The psalmist praised God because he was fearfully and wonderfully made. In Christ, there is now no condemnation, and anyone in Him is a new creation. Struggles, weaknesses, and scars are real, and some deserve care and help, but they are things you have, not the whole of who you are. God knows you completely and still calls you His workmanship.

> *“For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well”* (Psalm 139:13–14).

Also see

> “So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them” (Genesis 1:27).

> “For we are God’s workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life” (Ephesians 2:10).

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” (Romans 8:1).

> “Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!” (2 Corinthians 5:17).

Common self-statements

- Other people seem normal; I am not.
- If people really knew me, they would see what is wrong with me.
- I always mess things up because I am broken.
- Everyone else got something I was born without.
- When things go wrong, it must be my fault.
- I have to hide the real me.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Calling my whole self “wrong” because of a struggle, a mistake, or a painful feeling.
- Overgeneralization: Treating a few hard moments as proof that I am defective in every way.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing that because I feel broken, I must be broken.

- Personalization: Assuming that other people's anger, rejection, or problems were caused by something wrong in me.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I mean by "something is wrong with me"? Can I name it?
- When did I first start believing this, and who taught it to me?
- Is this a struggle I have, or is it the whole of who I am?
- Would I say this about a friend who had the same struggles I have?
- What evidence do I have that I am loved, valued, or capable?
- How does God describe the people He has made and redeemed?

Truth summary

> I have struggles, weaknesses, and wounds, like every person. But I am not a mistake. God made me in His image, knows me completely, and calls me His workmanship. My struggles are something I can work on and bring to Him; they are not the final word about who I am.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, By God
- God, Creator
- Guilt/Shame
- Thinking, Healthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Hello My Name Is — Matthew West
God's redeemed-child identity challenges labels of regret and defeat.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Something is wrong with me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Something is wrong with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I mean when I say something is wrong with me?
- ☐ Where did I first learn this belief?
- ☐ Is this something I have, or who I am?
- ☐ What would I say to a friend with the same struggle?
- ☐ What evidence says I am valued and capable?
- ☐ What does God say about the people He has made?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ Having a struggle does not make me defective.
- ☐ What was done to me does not define me.
- ☐ God knows me fully and still loves me.
- ☐ I can grow without first proving I am worth it.
- ☐ In Christ, there is no condemnation for me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 139:13–14**
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb. I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ **Ephesians 2:10**
  "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life."
- ☐ **Romans 8:1**
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When the "something is wrong with me" feeling came: Each day, write down one moment when you felt broken or different. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 139:13–14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God knit me together. I have struggles, but I am not a mistake; I am wonderfully made.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Separate the struggle from the self. Write the belief as "I am...". Then rewrite it as "I have..." or "I struggle with...". Notice how the second version feels.
- [ ] Collect the other side of the evidence. Ask one trusted person to tell you two good things they see in you. Write them down and read them, even if you do not believe them yet.
- [ ] Let one safe person see a little more of you. Share one small, honest thing about yourself with a trusted friend, family member, or church member. Notice whether they turn away or stay.
- [ ] Get help for what is real. If something truly needs attention, such as a health concern, a habit, or a painful memory, take one step toward help this week: a doctor, pastor, or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Something is wrong with me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I did not feel broken
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Something is wrong with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You formed me and You know me completely. When I feel broken or different, remind me that I am Your workmanship and not a mistake. Help me separate my struggles from who I am, bring my wounds to You for healing, and receive the love You have already given me in Christ. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.